business, planned with an international partner.

The institute has close to 1,500 students in its long-duration programmes, around 150 online learners and trains nearly 4,000 managers every year through executive education. According to Professor Arvind Sahay, director, "MDI ranks ninth in the National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF) and eighth nationally in the Financial Times rankings."

MDI's location in Gurugram gives it access to a wide range of businesses and opportunities for industry engagement. Its customised management development programmes draw on this close interaction with industry. The institute has recently revised its curriculum to include courses on technology and business, and geopolitics and business. Students are also being taught how to develop and use AI agents in their areas of work.

STUDENTSPEAK



TANISHQ MEHTA
PGDM-BFS, 1st year

"Case studies, corporate sessions and competitions give us a unique perspective. MDI Gurgaon ensures that we learn technical as well as soft skills"

The growing use of AI has prompted MDI to rethink how students learn and are assessed. Professor Sahay points out that when students depend on AI to summarise a case or do the analytical work for them, they may miss the thinking that makes learning meaningful. The institute, therefore, has introduced an AI policy and brought back pen-and-paper examinations for some assessments. Students are also asked to present what they have learnt and explain their understanding in their own words. The concern here is not the use of AI itself, but the risk of allowing it to do the thinking that students need to do for themselves.

MDI is also focusing on behavioural skills, teamwork and the ability to handle uncertainty. Its admissions process includes a behavioural assessment, while induction activities and courses encourage students to collaborate and build stronger working relationships.

Professor Sahay is of the opinion that good management education must bring together technology, human behaviour and sustainability. Knowledge of finance, marketing or supply chains remains important, but managers must also be able to work with people, make decisions under pressure and adapt to changing circumstances.

As business and the workplace continue to change, MDI's challenge is to ensure that its graduates can use technology effectively without losing the ability to think independently and lead people. ■

THE BEST LESSONS I LEARNT



AKASH GEHANI
Co-founder, Instamojo
Batch of 2009

"The most valuable lesson I learnt at MDI Gurgaon was to embrace uncertainty. Our hostel was called 'Change Masters', a name that stayed with us. We graduated in 2009, just after the global financial crisis had transformed the world we expected to enter. Careers, opportunities and assumptions had changed almost overnight. Seventeen years later, amid rapid technological disruption, that lesson matters even more today. Working in the start-up ecosystem has repeatedly taught me that even the best plans can unravel. You cannot anticipate every change, but you can remain nimble, keep learning and prepare yourself mentally to adapt to uncertainty."

MANAGEMENT DEVELOPMENT INSTITUTE (MDI) GURGAON, *GURUGRAM*

- **Established in: 1972**
- **Campus size: 35.11 acres**
- **Director: Prof. (Dr) Arvind Sahay**
- **Total students (1st and 2nd year): 1,206**
- **Share of female students: 24%**
- **Total faculty (permanent and visiting): 112**
- **Highest annual salary (domestic) earned by a student in 2026: ₹97.5 lakh**
- **Average annual salary (domestic) earned by students in 2026: ₹27.7 lakh**
- **Total number of recruiting companies in 2026: 155**
- **Total course fee (for two years): ₹21.3 lakh**
- **Placement record (2026): 100%**